

Minutes of the Meeting

Source File: TTSLONG-1.mp4

Date: May 04, 2026

Meeting Duration: 11m 25s

Executive Overview

The seminar discussed a 13-step roadmap for research, starting from finding the North Star, a guiding problem statement, to the final Polish.

The key concepts include authenticity, diversity of thought, intellectual integrity, and precision. The tasks are designed to help students avoid common pitfalls and build a bridge from curiosity to professional scholarship.

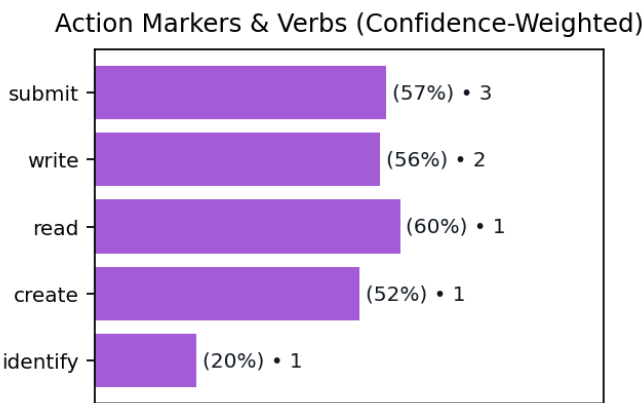
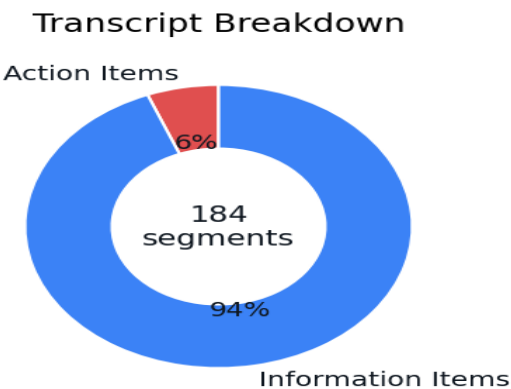
Topics Discussed

- 1. Assignment Briefing
- 2. North Star Identification
- 3. Information Gathering
- 4. Research Organization
- 5. Final Polish

Analytics Overview

Total sentences detected: 184. Suggested action items: 11. Information sentences: 173.

Common action markers: submit (3, 57%), write (2, 56%), read (1, 60%), create (1, 52%), identify (1, 20%)



Action Items

- [] Submit a 200-word mission pitch
Confidence: 52%. Basis: Action markers found: 'submit'
- [] Find four high-quality sources
Confidence: 12%. Basis: Matched action-item pattern.

[] Set up a knowledge basis

Confidence: 12%. Basis: Matched action-item pattern.

[] Show me your source matrix

Confidence: 12%. Basis: Matched action-item pattern.

[] Write a short positionality statement

Confidence: 52%. Basis: Action markers found: 'write'

[] Submit the word count of your zero draft

Confidence: 60%. Basis: Action markers found: 'submit'

[] Create one hero graphic

Confidence: 52%. Basis: Action markers found: 'create'

[] Submit a 30-second audio clip of your favorite paragraph

Confidence: 60%. Basis: Action markers found: 'submit'

[] Write a limitations and future research section

Confidence: 60%. Basis: Action markers found: 'write'

[] Identify one future variable that could change your results in the next decade

Confidence: 20%. Basis: Matched action-item pattern.

[] Read your paper from the last sentence to the first

Confidence: 60%. Basis: Action markers found: 'read'

Full Transcript

Good morning everyone! Come on in, find a spot that feels comfortable, and let's just take a second to settle in. I know your schedules are packed, your inboxes are overflowing, and the pressure of the semester is starting to feel a bit heavy. So, let's make this space different. Let's make this a no-pressure zone where the goal isn't just to check a box but to actually discover something that makes you excited to be here. In this seminar, we aren't just students and a teacher. We are a collective. Think of me as your lead consultant. I've been down this research path before, I've made the mistakes, and I've stayed up until 3. Oh, oh, I'm wondering if my thesis made any sense. My job today is to help you avoid those same pitfalls. We're going to walk through assignment number one, but we're going to do it together. I've broken it down into eight very manageable, very human tasks. We going to talk about what they are why they actually matter for your future and the absolute best way to get them done without burning out Your first basic task is finding your North Star In academic terms this is your problem statement, but I prefer to think of it as your North Star because it's the thing that's going to guide you when the research gets complicated. What is important here is authenticity. I see so many students pick a topic because they think it sounds smart or impressive to a professor. Please, don't do that. If you pick a topic you don't care about, the next 10 weeks are going to feel like a marathon in wet boots. Find something that genuinely sparks a weight that's not right or how does that actually work moment in your brain. Whether it's something in social media algorithms, environmental justice, or even the psychology of gaming, if it matters to you, it belongs here. The best way to do this is a technique I call the 5 whys. Start with a broad Let's say, urban parks. Ask yourself why they matter. Because people need green space. Why do they need it? For mental health. Why is that a problem right now? Because lower income areas have 40% less park access. Now you have a project. Your action item for this phase is to submit a 200-word mission pitch. Tell me what your North Star is and why you're the one to follow it. Once you have your North Star, we move to Task 2, the Information Treasure Hunt. This is the part where we move from I have a feeling to I have the facts.

You're going to find four high-quality sources, but I'm adding a twist to make it more interesting. What is important in this task is diversity of thought. If you only find sources that agree with you, you aren't researching, you're just looking in a mirror. I want you to find one classic source, the foundational theory, one modern source from the last two years, one data source numbers and charts, and the most important one, the devil's advocate source. This is the one that challenges your entire premise. The best way to execute this is to use our library's digital ask a librarian feature. Those folks are geniuses. They know shortcuts we haven't even dreamed of. Your deliverable for this task is a source map. For each of the four sources, write two sentences, one on what they say, and one on how they change your thinking. Your third task is the brain-trust collaboration. This is where we lean on each other. You're going to pair up with someone, preferably someone whose topic is totally different from yours, and you're going to do a concept swap. What is important here is perspective. When you've been staring at your own project for three days, you get in tunnel vision. Your partner is a fresh set of eyes. They can see the potholes in your plan before you drive over them. The best way to do this is the 3-2-1 feedback method. When you review your partner's work, give them three things you found interesting, two questions that their work raised, and one suggestion for a new direction. You'll submit a brief summary of that conversation. Remember, the best researchers in the world don't work alone. They have a brain trust of people they trust to tell them the truth. Once you have your hook and your feedback, your next task is the reality check. What is important in this task is objectivity. It's very easy to find people who agree with us on the internet. It's much harder to listen to the people who don't. But in a seminar, the best ideas are the ones that have been challenged. The best way to approach this is to use our university's library database. Avoid a basic Google search for this one. Look for peer-reviewed articles specifically. When you find that source that disagrees with you, don't ignore it. Use it to sharpen your own argument. Your deliverable here is a source summary where you explain how these different perspectives help you see the bigger picture. Now, we hit a hurdle that trips up even the most seasoned researchers. Organization, task 5 is what I call the digital architect. What is important here is traceability. There is nothing more heartbreaking than finding the perfect quote on a Tuesday and then spending 3 hours on a Friday trying to remember which PDF it came from. The best way to do this is to set up a knowledge basis right now. Whether you use Notion, Zotero or a well-organized Google Sheet, create a system where every source is linked to a specific theme. Your action item here is to show me your source matrix, a simple table that categorizes your main sources by their key arguments. If you build the house correctly now, you won't be living in a mess when we start writing. Task 6 is a bit deeper. It's the ethical compass. In our world of instant information, it's easy to borrow ideas without thinking about where they came from. What is important here is intellectual integrity. Scholarship is a conversation that has been happening for centuries, and you are now a guest at that table. The best way to handle this is to write a short positionality statement. Ask yourself, why am I interested in this, and what biases might I be bringing to the table? If you're writing about environmental justice but you've never lived in an affected area, acknowledge that perspective. Your deliverable is a 150-word reflection on how you plan to represent your sources fairly. We're getting closer to the finish line. Task 7 is the napkin blueprint. Before you write a single paragraph of your final draft, I want you to draw it. What is important in this task is logic flow. A good research project should tell a story. It should have an introduction that hooks us, a middle that challenges us, and a conclusion that gives us a call to action. The best way to do this is to grab a piece of paper, literally a napkin if you want, and sketch out the skeleton of your project. Use arrows to show how task 1 leads into task 2. If there's a gap in your drawing, there's a gap in your logic. You'll submit a photo of this sketch. Finally, we reach task 8, the zero draft sprint. This is the version where you're allowed to be messy, unpolished, and even a little bit confusing. What is important here is momentum. Perfectionism is the enemy of progress. If you try to make the first sentence perfect, you'll never get to the second one. The best way to execute this is to set a no backtrack rule. Set a timer for 45 minutes and write as much as you can. Do not hit the backspace key. If you forget a fact just write insert data

here and keep moving Your action item is to submit the word count of your zero draft I just want to see that you broken the blank pages barrier Once your zero draft is down we move to task nine the visual narrative We live in a world that consumes information through its eyes before its brain. What is important here is accessibility. If your research is a wall of text, you're locking people out. The best way to do this is to create one hero graphic. This could be a chart, a map, or an infographic that summarizes your entire North Star in one glance. You don't need to be a graphic designer. Use a tool like Canva or even a clean hand-drawn diagram. Your deliverable is this one visual. If a stranger can look at this image and understand your core argument in 10 seconds, you've mastered the art of communication. Task 10 is the acoustic test. This is where we find the musics in your writing. What is important in this task is flow and rhythm. Sometimes we write sentences that look fine on a screen but are impossible to say out loud without running out of breath. The best way to handle this is to record yourself reading your introduction and Your conclusion. Listen to it while you're walking or doing the dishes. Does it sound like you or does it sound like a robot wrote it? If you find yourself stumbling over a word, delete it. If a sentence feels too long, break it in two. Your action item is to submit a 30-second audio clip of your favorite paragraph. I want to hear your voice in your work. Now we get into the engineering side of research. Task 11, the structural stress test. What is important here is cohesion. Every paragraph in your project should act as a bridge to the next. If you remove a paragraph and the paper still makes sense, that paragraph was fluff. The best way to execute this is the reverse outline. Look at the first sentence of every paragraph you've written. Do they tell a story? Do they lead the reader from the problem to the solution? If they don't, you have a structural leak. Your deliverable is a sentence map. Just the first sentence of each section. If the logic holds up there, it will hold up everywhere. Task 12 is about legacy. The future proof audit. Most research is stuck in the now, but great research looks at the next. What is important in this task is sustainability. Ask yourself, will this project still matter in five years? What new technology or social change could make this irrelevant? The best way to do this is to write a limitations and future research section. Admit what you don't know. Identify the next question that someone else should answer. This doesn't show weakness. It shows that you understand the scale of the conversation. Your action item is to identify one future variable that could change your results in the next decade. Finally, we reach task 13, the final Polish. This isn't about the big ideas anymore. It's about fair respect you show your work. What is important here is precision. A typo is like a smudge on a camera lens. It distracts from the beautiful view you're trying to show. The best way to handle this is the bottom-up edit. Read your paper from the last sentence to the first. This tricks your brain into seeing the words as they actually are, rather than what you think they are. Check your citation. fix your margins, and ensure your name is on the front. To wrap everything up, you now have a 13-step roadmap. From finding your North Star to the final Polish, you have built a bridge from a simple spark of curiosity to a professional piece of scholarship. What is the absolute best way to finish? It's to click Submit and be proud of the version of yourself that started this two weeks ago. You didn't just check a box, you built something. All submission portals are open. I'm staying here for the rest of the session. If you're stuck on task 1 or task 13, come talk to me. I've got your back. But before I let you go, I want to talk about the messy middle. Between now and the deadline, you are going to feel lost. You're going to think your topic is too big or your sources are too confusing. What is important here is self-compassion. Research is a non-linear process. It's okay to pivot. The best way to handle this is the Pomodoro technique. Set a timer for 25 minutes. Do nothing but research, then walk away. Your brain needs downtime to connect the dots. To wrap things up, you have your roadmap, from finding your North Star all the way to the Zero Draft Sprint. Stay curious and stay connected. All the details and submission links are live on the portal. We have the rest of this hour to start the brain dump for your North Star. I'll be circulating around. Grab me if you want to bounce an idea off me. You've got this and I've got your back. Let's get to work.